

Dental, Vision & Hearing — DVH

The Gap Medicare Won't Fill (And How You Do)

Original Medicare barely touches dental, vision, or hearing. Here's what every U.S. Medicare agent needs to know — and why it's one of your most powerful client conversations.

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■ KILL SWITCH — VERIFY BEFORE EVERY USE

- MA plan DVH benefits change every January 1. Always verify current plan year benefits in the carrier's Evidence of Coverage (EOC).
- Standalone DVH plans are NOT Medicare products. Regulated by state Departments of Insurance, not CMS.
- DVH benefit allowances vary significantly by plan, carrier, and county. Never quote specific dollar amounts without verifying the current plan.
- CHRONIC Care Act expanded MA supplemental benefits starting 2019. Confirm with CMS for any subsequent changes.
- Approximately 5,600 Medicare Advantage plans available nationwide in 2026 (CMS). DVH benefits vary widely among them.

"One of the first things I ask every new client is: when did you last see a dentist? You can tell a lot about someone's coverage situation from that answer. Most seniors on Original Medicare haven't been in years — not because they don't want to go, but because they think they can't afford it. That's your opening."

WHAT ORIGINAL MEDICARE DOES AND DOES NOT COVER

This is not a gray area. Original Medicare (Parts A and B) does NOT cover routine dental cleanings, fillings, dentures, routine eye exams, eyeglasses, hearing exams, or hearing aids. Many U.S. Medicare beneficiaries discover this for the first time sitting in a dentist's chair or at an optometrist's office. Your job is to tell them before that moment — and offer a solution.

Benefit	Original Medicare	Typical MA Plan	Standalone DVH
Routine dental cleanings	NOT covered	Often covered	Covered

Dental X-rays	NOT covered	Often covered	Covered
Fillings	NOT covered	Varies by plan	Usually covered
Dentures / Implants	NOT covered	Varies; limits apply	Varies; limits apply
Routine eye exams	NOT covered	Often covered	Covered
Eyeglasses / Contacts	NOT covered (except post-cataract)	Allowance offered	Covered up to limit
Hearing exams	NOT covered	Often covered	Covered
Hearing aids	NOT covered	Allowance (\$500–\$2,500/ear)*	Covered to plan limit
Cataract surgery / lenses	Covered under Part B	Covered	N/A
Glaucoma screening	Covered (Part B, high-risk only)	Covered	N/A

**Kill Switch: MA DVH allowances change annually. Verify in the plan's current Evidence of Coverage before quoting.*

HOW MEDICARE ADVANTAGE FILLS THE DVH GAP

Since 2019, under the CHRONIC Care Act, Medicare Advantage plans have had expanded flexibility to offer supplemental benefits including dental, vision, and hearing. The depth of coverage varies enormously by plan, carrier, and county. A plan in one Louisiana parish may offer \$3,000 in annual dental benefits. The same carrier in the next parish over may offer \$500. Never assume. Always verify.

■ **SEASONED AGENT TIP:** When comparing MA plans for a client who regularly uses dental or vision services, use the Medicare Plan Finder to filter by these benefits specifically. A plan with a \$0 premium and weak DVH coverage may cost more annually than a \$30/month plan with strong coverage once the client actually uses their benefits.

STANDALONE DVH PLANS — FOR YOUR MEDIGAP CLIENTS

Clients on Original Medicare + Medigap don't receive Medicare Advantage benefits. For DVH coverage, they need a standalone plan — a private insurance product regulated by state Departments of Insurance, not CMS. These plans come with their own rules: waiting periods for major services, annual maximums, and network structures that differ from MA dental networks.

■ **FIELD WARNING:** Standalone DVH plans are NOT Medicare products. Never use Medicare marketing materials, the CMS logo, or Medicare branding when selling these plans. Representing a private DVH plan as a Medicare product is a compliance violation subject to state DOI enforcement action.

Feature	Typical U.S. Market Range
Monthly premium	\$30 – \$80/month
Dental annual maximum	\$1,000 – \$2,000
Waiting period (major services)	Often 6–12 months

Network type	PPO or direct reimbursement; broader than MA dental HMO networks
Vision exam copay	\$10 – \$25
Hearing aid coverage	Varies by plan; often limited or available as a separate rider

Ranges are illustrative of the U.S. market. Kill Switch: Always verify current carrier rates before quoting.

THE DISCOVERY QUESTIONS THAT OPEN EVERY DVH CONVERSATION

- When did you last see a dentist? Do you still have a dentist you go to regularly?
- Do you wear glasses or contacts? When was your last eye exam?
- Have you ever been told you might benefit from hearing aids?
- Are you putting off any dental or vision work because of cost?
- How important are dental, vision, and hearing benefits when you think about your coverage?
- Would you prefer everything bundled in one plan, or are you comfortable with separate coverage?

"The DVH conversation is not about selling an add-on. It's about asking your client when they last took care of themselves — and then showing them how to afford to do it again. That's not insurance. That's care."

VERIFIED U.S. RESOURCES & CITATIONS

CMS — Medicare Dental Coverage

<https://www.medicare.gov/coverage/dental-services>

Official CMS page on what Original Medicare does and does not cover for dental services.

CMS — Medicare Vision Coverage

<https://www.medicare.gov/coverage/eye-exams>

Official CMS coverage details for eye exams and eyeglasses.

CMS — Medicare Hearing Coverage

<https://www.medicare.gov/coverage/hearing-aids>

Official CMS coverage rules for hearing exams and hearing aids.

CHRONIC Care Act — CMS Summary

<https://www.cms.gov/newsroom/fact-sheets/2018-medicare-advantage-and-part-d-advance-notice-part-i>

CMS summary of expanded MA supplemental benefit flexibility enacted 2019.

Medicare Plan Finder — DVH Filter

<https://www.medicare.gov/plan-compare/>

Compare MA plans by DVH benefit level in your client's zip code. Kill Switch: Plans change annually.

YOUR NEXT STEP: AgentRisePro

The Medicare Agent Workspace built by a 25-year U.S. Medicare field veteran — for U.S. agents who are serious about AEP.

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Solo independent agent AEP launch special	Full features + Voice AI when live	Multi-agent teams White label ready
Script Desk Launch Kit Calendar Basic CRM	Everything in Pilot + GPT Voice (coming) + Advanced CRM + Carrier Tools	Everything in Pro + Team Dashboard + Agency Reporting + Priority Support
Annual: \$368/yr (Save \$88 — 2 mo free)	Annual: \$658/yr (Save \$158 — 2 mo free)	Annual: \$803/yr (Save \$193 — 2 mo free)

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- Agent Launch Kit — all 5 briefs + 100+ questions
- Fresh Pour — agent community & audio lounge
- Training Calendar — built-in appointment by block
- Book of Business CRM — track your U.S. agents
- GPT Voice AI — hands-free in the car (coming Q1 2027)
- Download & share tools
- U.S. carrier reference library
- CMS compliance reminders built in

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